YUANYUAN XU

Ph.D. Candidate, Interdisciplinary Studies
Faculty of Creative & Critical Studies, University of British Columbia

EDUCATION

2025 – 2029 **Ph.D. Candidate in Interdisciplinary Studies**
University of British Columbia
Faculty of Creative & Critical Studies. Co-supervised by Prof. Aleksandra Dulic (Professor, FCCS) and Prof. Patricia Lasserre (Associate Professor, Computer Science). Research: co-designing educational games with Indigenous communities for environmental resilience. Fully funded: OGRS (CAD $40,000/year) and IDPT tuition award. Advanced to Ph.D. candidacy on 30 October 2026.

2020 – 2023 **M.Eng. in Design**
Tongji University, Shanghai — College of Design and Innovation
Full Scholarship (¥32,000). Graduate Commencement Speaker (2023).

2016 – 2020 **B.A. in Product Design**
East China University of Science and Technology, Shanghai
GPA: 3.7/4.0, Rank first in major for 4 consecutive years. National Scholarship (Top 0.2%, ¥8,000). Cheng Si-wei Honorary Principal's Scholarship (Top 1%). Grand Prize Academic Scholarship (5 consecutive semesters). Person of the Year Nominee. Role Model Ambassador. Shanghai Outstanding Graduate (Top 2%). Graduate Commencement Speaker (2020).

2023 – 2025 **Diploma in Game Design, Animation, and VFX**
Think Tank Training Centre, Vancouver
Full-cycle game production pipeline: 3D animation, VFX, and game design.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

Y. Xu, Z. Sun, C. Zhen, Y.-S. Lin, T.H. Sarker, M. Thorogood, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic. "From Engagement to Resilience: A Systematic Review of Game-Based Learning for Environmental Resilience." Sustainability, 18(5), 2305, 2026. doi.org/10.3390/su18052305

Y. Xu*, X. Shan, M. Guo, W. Gao, Y.-S. Lin. "Design and Application of Experience Management Tools from the Perspective of Customer Perceived Value." World Electric Vehicle Journal, 15(8), 378, 2024. doi.org/10.3390/wevj15080378

Y. Xu*, W. Gao, Y. Wang, X. Shan, Y.-S. Lin. "Enhancing User Experience and Trust in Advanced LLM-Based Conversational Agents." Computing and Artificial Intelligence, 2(2), 1467, 2024. doi.org/10.59400/cai.v2i2.1467

Y. Xu*, Y.-S. Lin, X. Zhou, X. Shan. "Utilizing Emotion Recognition Technology to Enhance User Experience in Real-Time." Computing and Artificial Intelligence, 2(1), 1388, 2024. doi.org/10.59400/cai.v2i1.1388

M. Liu*, M. Guo, L. Jiang, Y. Xu. "Kansei Engineering–Based Product Form Design: Eye-Tracking on Drinkware." Journal of the University of Shanghai, 42(5), 2020. doi.org/10.13255/j.cnki.jusst.20191122008

Y. Xu*, Y. Bao, B. Yang. "Design Analysis of Therapeutic Toys for Children with Autism." Art and Technology, 2018.

M. Liu*, M. Guo, L. Jiang, Y. Xu. "Exploring the Relationship Between Eye-Tracking Data and Product Form Design." Literature Life, 2019. doi.org/10.3969/j.issn.1005-5312.2019.10.029

Conference Papers & Book Chapters

Z. Sun, Y. Xu, C. Zhen, M. Smith. "“You Were Never Meant to Win”: A Taxonomy of Scripted Loss in Digital Games." Companion Proceedings of the ACM CHI PLAY 2026, pp. 7-13, 2026. doi.org/10.1145/3800965.3834328

C. Zhen, Y. Xu, Z. Sun, A. Dulic, M. Thorogood. "Sound as the Score: Designing Progressive Audio Layering as Embodied Music Reward." Companion Proceedings of the ACM CHI PLAY 2026, pp. 261-266, 2026. doi.org/10.1145/3800965.3834330

Y. Xu, T.H. Sarker, C. Zhen, O. Nwosisi, A. Rahsaz, M. Thorogood, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic. "Beaver World: Decolonizing Climate Education through Place-Based Interactive Simulation." Proceedings of the ACM SIGGRAPH 2026 Educator's Forum, pp. 1-3, 2026. doi.org/10.1145/3799829.3812512

Y. Xu, Z. Sun, C. Zhen, Y.-S. Lin, M. Thorogood, M. Smith, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic. "Mapping Ecological Empathy: A Semantic Network Analysis of Player Perceptions in 3D Environmental Education Games." HCI International 2026, LNCS 15749, Springer, 2026. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-30405-6_16

C. Zhen, Y. Xu, C.S. Souto, Z. Sun, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic, M. Thorogood. "Animation Design Philosophy in 3D Educational Games: The Development of Beaver World." HCI International 2026 Posters, CCIS, Springer, 2026. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-30816-0_41

Z. Sun, Y. Xu, C. Zhen, Y.-S. Lin, M. Thorogood, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic, M. Smith. "Struggle as Flow: Challenge, Design, and Experience in Soulslike Games." HCI International 2026, LNCS 15749, Springer, 2026. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-30405-6_15

Y. Xu, Z. Sun, Y.-S. Lin, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic. "The Absent Teacher in Eco-Games: A Theoretical Framework for Teacher Integration in Eco-Games." DiGRA 2026.

Y. Xu, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic. "From Resource to Kin: Designing for Environmental Resilience in the Okanagan." DiGRA 2026.

Z. Sun, Y. Xu, Y.-S. Lin, P. Lasserre, A. Dulic, M. Smith. "Re-evaluating the Pursuit of Hyper-Realism in VR Game Design Through Ludo-Proprioceptive Dissonance." DiGRA 2026.

X. Shan, Y. Xu*, Y. Wang, T. Xia, Y.-S. Lin. "Designing Wine Tasting Experiences for All." HCII 2025, CCIS 2772, Springer, 2026. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-12767-9_42

Y. Xu*, X. Shan, Y.-S. Lin, J. Wang. "AI-Enhanced Tools for Cross-Cultural Game Design." HCII 2024, LNCS 15377, Springer, 2025. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-76812-5_29

X. Shan, Y. Xu*, Y. Wang, Y.-S. Lin, Y. Bao. "Cross-Cultural Implications of Large Language Models." HCII 2024, LNCS 15375, Springer, 2025. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-76806-4_8

T. Xia*, Y. Xu, X. Shan. "KOA-Monitor: A Digital Intervention and Functional Assessment System." HCII 2025, LNCS 15810, Springer, 2025. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-92710-2_26

X. Shan, Y. Xu, T. Xia, Y.-S. Lin. "Rethinking Wine Tasting for Chinese Consumers." 2025 IEEE International Conference on Content-Based Multimedia Indexing (CBMI), 2025.

Y. Xu*, Y.-S. Lin. "Exploring the Influence of User-Perceived Value on NEV-Enterprises." FFIT 2024, Atlantis Press, 2024. doi.org/10.2991/978-94-6463-572-0_2

G. Tian, Y. Xu*. "A Study on the Typeface Design Method of Han Characters Imitated Tangut." AEHSSR, 2022. doi.org/10.56028/aehssr.2.1.270

Patents

2023 X. Sun et al., Y. Xu. "FPGA-Based Vision Method for Blind Navigation" (CN110070514B). Chinese Patent Office. Granted.

PRESENTATIONS

Jun 2026	Y. Xu et al. "Mapping Ecological Empathy: A Semantic Network Analysis of Player Perceptions in 3D Environmental Education Games." HCI International Conference (HCII) 2026, Palais des congrès de Montréal.
Jun 2026	Y. Xu et al. Doctoral Consortium and Education Session. Digital Games Research Association Conference (DiGRA) 2026, Ireland.
Jul 2026	Y. Xu et al. "Beaver World: Decolonizing Climate Education through Place-Based Interactive Simulation." ACM SIGGRAPH 2026 Educator's Forum, Los Angeles Convention Center — 20-minute invited talk.
2025	Y. Xu, Y.-S. Lin. "Situated Bodies, Wandering Minds." ACM SIGGRAPH Conference on Computer Graphics and Interactive Techniques (SIGGRAPH) 2025, Vancouver — Birds of a Feather (BOF) Session.
2024	Y. Xu. "Creativity for Sensational Perception." HCI International Conference (HCII) 2024, Washington DC.
2023	Y. Xu. Graduate Commencement Speech. Tongji University.
2020	Y. Xu. Graduate Commencement Speech. East China University of Science and Technology.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING

Jul 2026 **Lecturer — Game UI/UX Design**
Shanghai University — Vancouver Film School (VFS)
Designed and delivered a standalone Game UI/UX module covering game interface fundamentals, pixel art aesthetics, Figma production workflow, and UI design specification documents.

2025 – 2027 **Student Researcher — SSHRC Insight Grant**
University of British Columbia
Okanagan WaterFutures: Experiential Games for Water Responsibility (CAD $313,360; grant period 2023 – 2027). PIs: Aleksandra Dulic, Miles Thorogood, Patricia Lasserre, Anna Warwick.

2025 – 2027 **Student Researcher — NSERC CREATE Program (CITech)**
University of British Columbia
Immersive Technologies (CITech) (CAD $4,184,800; $1.65M NSERC, $1M UBC, $2.4M industry committed funding; program period 2021 – 2027). Director: Abbas Sadeghzadeh Milani et al.

Sep 2025 – present **Research Assistant — Center for Culture and Technology**
University of British Columbia
Beaver Worlds Project: participatory game design for Okanagan water governance and Indigenous knowledge mobilisation.

Jan 2026 – present **Teaching Assistant — CCS 325: AI & Creativity**
University of British Columbia
Grading, tutorial sessions, student feedback, facilitating activities on generative AI and creative coding.

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026 **Marker — CCS 330: Game Design**
University of British Columbia
Grading assignments and providing written feedback for a game design course.

2018 – 2020 **Teaching Assistant — Design Graphics (Shanghai Municipal Premium Course)**
East China University of Science and Technology
Technical drawing, digital illustration, and design fundamentals.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

2022 – 2023 **Product Manager — iXp Program — SAP Labs, SAP Analytics Cloud, Shanghai**
Led UX and analytics initiatives; organised workshops; facilitated demos and user testing.

2020	**Product Manager Intern — Siemens, Intelligent Infrastructure, Shanghai** Customer training for Siemens Distribution Panel Model 8PT.
2020	**UX Designer Intern — Shanghai Jahwa, Consumer Products** User research and UX design for consumer product digital platforms.
2017 – 2019	**Co-founder — SharePlay, Shanghai** Recreational equipment sharing platform. National Gold Award, China Youth Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) — Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviewing, three times (two in 2025, one in 2026)
ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS) ACM Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST) ACM Symposium on Eye Tracking Research and Applications (ETRA)
ACM International Conference on Interactive Media Experiences (IMX) ACM Conference on Conversational User Interfaces (CUI)
ACM Conference on Automotive User Interfaces and Interactive Vehicular Applications (AutoUI)
IEEE International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality (ISMAR) IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces (IEEE VR)
Eurographics/IEEE Conference on Visualization (EuroVis)
Computer-Aided Architectural Design Research in Asia (CAADRIA) — International Review Committee Member
International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IJHCI) (2026) Innovation Technology Advances (ITA)

SELECTED AWARDS & HONOURS

2025	Okanagan Graduate Research Scholarship (OGRS) — University of British Columbia, CAD $40,000/year, 4-year doctoral funding
2025	International Doctoral Partial Tuition Award (IDPT) — University of British Columbia
2025–2026	Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviewing, three times (two in 2025, one in 2026) — ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
2025	Rookie of the Year — A Ranking (Game) — The Rookies Awards (Exceptional, Industry-Ready Skills)
2024	Rookie of the Year — A Ranking (VFX and 3D Animation) — The Rookies Awards (Exceptional, Industry-Ready Skills)
2023	Graduate Commencement Speaker — Tongji University
2021	Full Scholarship (¥32,000) — Tongji University
2021	Bronze Award — International Ocean Art Festival (IOAF) Starfish International Young Artists Exhibition
2020	Shanghai Outstanding Graduate (Top 2%) — Shanghai Municipal Education Commission
2020	Graduate Commencement Speaker — East China University of Science and Technology
2019	National First Prize — FPGA Blind Navigation — "Challenge Cup" National College Students' Extracurricular Academic Science and Technology Works Competition
2018	National Gold Award — SharePlay — "Chuang Qingchun" China Youth Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition
2017	National Scholarship (Top 0.2%, ¥8,000) — Ministry of Education, People's Republic of China
2016–2019	Cheng Si-wei Honorary Principal's Scholarship (Top 1%) — East China University of Science and Technology
2016–2019	Grand Prize Academic Scholarship — First in Major, 5 semesters — East China University of Science and Technology

RESEARCH GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

2025 **Okanagan Graduate Research Scholarship (OGRS) + International Doctoral Partial Tuition Award (IDPT)**
University of British Columbia. 4-year doctoral funding.

2025 – 2027 **SSHRC Insight Grant — CAD 313,360**
Student Researcher. "Okanagan WaterFutures: Experiential Games for Water Responsibility" (PIs: Aleksandra Dulic, Miles Thorogood, Patricia Lasserre, Anna Warwick)

2025 – 2027 **NSERC Collaborative Research and Training Experience Program (CREATE) — CAD 4,184,800 ($1.65M NSERC, $1M UBC, $2.4M Industry)**
Student Researcher. "Immersive Technologies (CITech)" (PIs: Abbas Sadeghzadeh Milani, Joan Bottorff, John Braun, Kenneth Chau, Aleksandra Dulic, Fatemeh Fard, Mohammad Khalad Hasan, Zheng Liu, Homayoun Najjaran, Brodie Sakakibara, Patricia Lasserre)

2022 **Shanghai Technology Entrepreneurship Foundation (EFG) — RMB 500,000**
PI. "Designing Childhood: Play, Emotion, and Soft Toys."

2017 **Shanghai First-Class Discipline Construction Fund**
Student Researcher. "Kansei-Based User Perception Analysis."

2017 **NSFC (Project No. 51905175)**
Student Researcher. "Kansei Engineering Product Form Design."

2017 **Shanghai College Student Innovation Program (No. X18223)**
Team Leader.

2017 **Shanghai Student Innovation & Entrepreneurship Training (EFG)**
Applicant.